Drawing of another Satavahana coin from the Indraji bequest, showing a two-masted Roman ship. It carries the name of Sri Vasishthiputra Sri Pulumavi, ruler of Paithan c. 110–138 CE and known to the historian Ptolemy the Elder as Siriptolemaios.

From an Indian perspective this Roman coinage was valued only for its worth as bullion, to be melted down and reworked into bangles and other ornaments, hence the hoards. Even so, this flood of coins carrying the names and portraits of Roman emperors seems to have encouraged the Satavahana kings to follow suit, the first to do so being Gautamiputra Satakarni (see illustration), following his defeat of the so-called Western Kshatrapas (Satraps) in the north-west in about 100 CE – a victory that marked the start of a third revival of the dynasty's fortunes.

An inscription on the wall of a rock-cut cave in Nasik placed there by Gautamiputra Satakarni's mother describes him as the conqueror who 'crushed down the pride and conceit of the Kshatriyas [the Arya Rajputs], who destroyed the Sakas [Western Kshatrapas], Yavanas [Indo-Greeks] and Pahlavas [Indo-Parthians], who rooted out the Khakharata family [of Nahapana, the Kshatrapa ruler who had earlier defeated the Satavahanas], who restored the glory of the Satavahana race'.[4] It goes on to declare Gautamiputra lord of the Vindhya, Malaya, Mahendra, Krishnagiri and other mountain ranges, whose horses drank from the waters of three oceans, which suggests that he also briefly conquered the Cholas and the Pandyas in the far south.

This inscription declares Gautamiputra Satakarni to be an *ekabrahmana*, or 'one Brahmin',[5] yet he also appears to have been a major patron of Buddhism, because under his aegis the Krishna River region became not only the central hub of the Satavahana empire but also a major centre of Buddhist activity in India. A similar policy of religious tolerance appears to have been followed by other Satavahana kings. A donor's inscription on the first of the four magnificent gateways of the Great Stupa at Sanchi